

EL PASO HERALD-

Prep Baseball

Irvin Hits Stride

Ysleta looked ahead, Bel Air didn't and man you oughta see those "Batgirls" at Irvin!

Bel Air gained a two game advantage in District 2-AAAA yesterday by trouncing El Paso High 5-1 while Bowie's Juan Sanchez four-hit second place Ysleta, 2-1. The 1-AAAA race was knotted up when Irvin roasted Eastwood 9-2 while Burges fell 2-0 to south-paw Ricky Baca and the Adress squad.

"This makes it a new ball game," Rockets' coach Bob Berryhill stated afterward. "We're hitting the ball well and our defense is showing up every game. Bobby Rodriguez (the Rockets starter) has been pitching with a sore shoulder but he's doing a great job for us. We have to play them one at a time from here."

That would have been a great lesson for Ysleta. The Indians weren't looking ahead as much as Bowie's Sanchez was looking down their throats, however. Two first inning runs were all the Bears' righthander needed in posting his initial victory in district play after one loss.

BEL AIR got its normal dose of nine hits which Bobby Hernandez made more than enough with his five-hitter over El Paso. The Clan stomped the plate twice in the fifth, and again two times in the seventh for the win. El Paso's only run came on a fourth inning 'tater' by right-fielder Charlie Campos.

Coronado tripped Austin, 7-5 behind Hank Cohen. The Thunderbirds used a five run fifth to ice the game.

Adress' Baca survived a shaky start and then tamed 1-AAAA power Burges on four hits at the Mustangs' field. The Eagles scored twice after two were out in the fifth when shortstop Steve Burciaga couldn't find the handle on a groundball. Doug Goodwin suffered the loss.